

because mobility is pointless without communications. The next thing we decided we needed was PDA functionality, because things like address books and e-mail need to be available on demand and easily—as they are in PDAs. Then we decided to get greedy, and wanted laptop functionality as well, because, well, why not?

It would be nice to have a gadget that gave you the quick usefulness of a PDA, but when required, would let you open up Photoshop to edit the image you just clicked, or play your favourite games! And while we're adding a laptop, we thought, "Oh what the hell, why not make it a tablet PC as well..."

GOD

We decided that GOD should be no bigger than a current PDA—after all, why would anyone want to lug around a device any larger than that in the first place? So the dimensions were fixed at a maximum of 140 x 100 x 30 mm (h x w x d). We really don't like the idea of holding up such a gadget to our ears in order to use the cell phone functionality, so the first thing we did was add a Bluetooth headset. Ironical that we started on the bundled goodies even before we started designing the device itself, isn't it?

Now that we had settled on how it would be used as a phone, we decided we needed to have a look at the front fascia. Number keys were a must, and if it was going to be a PDA as well, screen area was worth its space in gold. We decided to offer most of the front face as a screen, no buttons at all.

This is an imaginary scenario, so we decided that batteries are supercharged, and can last for days, even with the screen and Bluetooth turned on all the time. Also, storage is not a problem, as the device uses a non-volatile RAM/HDD (see www.atomchip.com).

So we designed the front display to have two modes: phone and PDA. In phone mode, the display is divided in two, with one part displaying virtual QWERTY or number keys, which can be used as normal keys thanks to touchscreens, and the other part acting as the regular phone display. Only when required, would GOD switch to PDA mode. Now the problem was that we needed a trigger for this to happen. Sure, we could just add a PDA mode virtual button, but that wasn't cool enough.

We decided that apart from adding a PDA mode switch into the phone menu, we would also add a trigger in the stylus mechanism—pull out the stylus, and GOD switches into PDA mode. Cool, isn't it?



Gadget of Our Dreams—GOD! Here you can see GOD in phone mode. Those buttons aren't real buttons, instead they're just images of buttons on the touchscreen display



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